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China Autos & Shared Mobility | Asia Pacific

WAIC Takeaways – Implications for Auto Parts

WAIC 2026 presents opportunities for auto suppliers to enter the humanoid robot realm. Meanwhile, as competition intensifies, it's getting harder for suppliers to select customers, differentiate products and retain R&D talent.

The Shanghai World Artificial Intelligence Conference (WAIC) 2026, held on 17-20 July, was even more crowded than 2025's conference, with 300+ humanoid robots on show this year vs. 150+ last year. Here, we focus on implications for auto suppliers and challenges we foresee.

Challenge #1: Customer selection becomes more difficult. With the rising number of humanoid robots, it's getting harder to gauge which robot integrators will emerge as clear leaders. Winning orders from leading customers such as Tesla (TSLA.O, covered by Andrew Percoco) and Unitree remains tough, while for small-volume customers, suppliers' upfront R&D and capacity may be more profitably utilized elsewhere. We think auto parts suppliers are more favorably positioned – they can leverage existing R&D resources, CNC machining equipment, and material sourcing channels to serve robot customers, and thus incur less upfront investment.

Challenge #2: Product offerings are converging. Last year, humanoid suppliers tended to have an area of focus, but now they tend to offer as many products as possible. For example, Joyson (600699.SS) has introduced dexterous hands (TeleHand), in addition to AI head assembly, electronic skin, brain domain controllers, and solid liquid hybrid batteries. Sanhua (002050.SZ) has extended its product portfolio from actuators to hand modules and sensors, per management guidance. Zhongding (000887.SS, NC), Zhenyu (300953.SZ, NC), and Lens (300433.SZ, covered by Derrick Yang), for example, all make joints, hands, limbs, and sensors. The convergence of product offerings may intensify competition.

Challenge #3: R&D talent requires incentives to stay. For most listed auto parts suppliers, earnings and share prices came under pressure in 1H26 because of weak domestic auto demand, ongoing price competition, and rising material costs. However, on the opposite side, humanoid start-ups are attracting VC/PE investors at substantial valuations. This presents challenges for auto parts companies to retain talent, and we think it could also spur them to consider spinning off in-house humanoid teams and provide stock incentives.

Connecting earnings with dreams: For 2Q/1H26, OEM price cuts, material cost hikes, higher social insurance contributions, and FX losses could pressure earnings at many auto parts suppliers we cover. Investors appear attracted by the humanoid angle, but they are also concerned about near-term earnings. We prefer Minth (0425.HK; OW) to play the humanoid story, as it also has a solid earnings outlook (double-digit YoY growth for FY26, per guidance) to support valuation.

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CHINA AUTOS & SHARED MOBILITY

Asia Pacific

Industry View

In-Line

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Valuation Methodology and Risks

Minth Group Limited (0425.HK)

Base case, derived from DCF valuation. Our key assumptions include a 13% WACC (15.3% cost of equity and 6.3% cost of debt), a 9% medium-term growth rate, and a 3% terminal growth rate.

Risks to Upside

- More new project/client wins than expected for its aluminium battery housing products
- Faster-than-expected overseas market expansion
- Humanoid project wins

Risks to Downside

- Significant long-term slowdown in China's PV market
- Sluggish overseas market sales growth
- Labor cost increases

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(as of June 30, 2026)

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Stock Rating Category	Coverage Universe		Investment Banking Clients (IBC)			Other Material Investment Services Clients (MISC)	
	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1544	42%	453	49%	29%	757	44%
Equal-weight/Hold	1577	43%	390	42%	25%	769	44%
Not-Rated/Hold	3	0%	1	0%	33%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	544	15%	89	10%	16%	204	12%
Total	3,668		933			1731	

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

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Stock Price, Price Target and Rating History (See Rating Definitions)

Minth Group Limited (0425.HK) - As of 07/20/26 GMT in HKD
Industry : China Autos & Shared Mobility



Stock Rating History: 7/1/21 : 0/C; 9/1/21 : 0/A; 8/25/22 : 0/I

Price Target History: 3/3/21 : 44; 3/1/22 : 42; 4/13/22 : 28; 1/8/24 : 22; 8/7/24 : 15; 1/13/25 : 19; 2/28/25 : 26; 11/12/25 : 43; 2/25/26 : 50; 6/15/26 : 51

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Date Format : MM/DD/YY

Price Target --

No Price Target Assigned (NA)

Stock Price (Not Covered by Current Analyst) — Stock Price (Covered by Current Analyst) —

Stock and Industry Ratings (abbreviations below) appear as ♦ Stock Rating/Industry View

Stock Ratings: Overweight (O) Equal-weight (E) Underweight (U) Not-Rated (NR) No Rating Available (NA)

Industry View: Attractive (A) In-line (I) Cautious (C) No Rating (NR)

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INDUSTRY COVERAGE: China Autos & Shared Mobility

COMPANY (TICKER)	RATING (AS OF)	PRICE* (07/20/2026)
Joey Xu, CFA		
Anhui Jianghuai Automobile (600418.SS)	E (08/19/2023)	Rmb21.05
BAIC Motor (1958.HK)	E (10/02/2025)	HK\$0.84
Brilliance China Automotive (1114.HK)	E (03/31/2025)	HK\$2.02
Chongqing Changan Automobile (000625.SZ)	E (03/03/2026)	Rmb7.28
Guangzhou Automobile Group (601238.SS)	U (10/23/2019)	Rmb5.18
Guangzhou Automobile Group (2238.HK)	O (05/05/2020)	HK\$2.18
Huayu Automotive (600741.SS)	O (09/08/2020)	Rmb17.05
Jiangsu Changshu Automotive Trim Group (603035.SS)	E (08/14/2023)	Rmb10.85
Ningbo Huaxiang Electronic Co., Ltd. (002048.SZ)	E (05/05/2026)	Rmb18.43
SAIC Motor Corp. Ltd. (600104.SS)	O (11/25/2021)	Rmb10.60
Voyah Automotive Technology Co. Ltd. (7489.HK)	O (03/31/2026)	HK\$2.98
Zhengzhou Yutong Bus Co (600066.SS)	E (09/22/2023)	Rmb32.09
Shelley Wang, CFA		
Beijing Jingwei Hirain Technologies (688326.SS)	U (09/27/2024)	Rmb63.61
Bethel Automotive Safety Systems Co Ltd (603596.SS)	O (12/11/2023)	Rmb23.00
Changzhou Xingyu Automotive Lighting Sys (601799.SS)	O (09/27/2024)	Rmb88.42
China MeiDong Auto Holdings Ltd (1268.HK)	U (07/10/2026)	HK\$0.48
China Yongda Automobiles Services (3669.HK)	U (07/10/2026)	HK\$0.89
Foryou Corporation (002906.SZ)	O (03/06/2024)	Rmb23.20
Fuyao Glass Industry Group (600660.SS)	E (12/01/2016)	Rmb54.94
Fuyao Glass Industry Group (3606.HK)	E (12/01/2016)	HK\$55.45
Huizhou Desay SV Automotive Co Ltd (002920.SZ)	O (02/28/2025)	Rmb83.40
Keboda (603786.SS)	O (01/17/2024)	Rmb40.18
Minth Group Limited (0425.HK)	O (08/24/2015)	HK\$26.80
NavInfo Co Ltd (002405.SZ)	U (03/06/2024)	Rmb6.14
Nexteer Automotive Group (1316.HK)	E (02/28/2025)	HK\$3.99
Ningbo Joyson Electronic Corp (600699.SS)	E (03/11/2026)	Rmb19.97

Ningbo Tuopu Group Co Ltd (601689.SS)	E (11/12/2025)	Rmb48.52
Ningbo Xusheng Group Co Ltd (603305.SS)	E (06/18/2025)	Rmb10.80
Suzhou Recodeal Interconnect System (688800.SS)	O (07/02/2026)	Rmb56.30
TUHU Car Inc (9690.HK)	O (07/29/2024)	HK\$13.42
Zhejiang Sanhua Intelligent Controls (002050.SZ)	E (11/12/2025)	Rmb36.12
Zhongsheng Group Holdings (0881.HK)	E (07/10/2026)	HK\$4.41
Tim Hsiao		
BAIC BluePark New Energy (600733.SS)	U (08/07/2024)	Rmb4.70
BYD Company Limited (002594.SZ)	O (04/14/2025)	Rmb93.92
BYD Company Limited (1211.HK)	O (04/14/2025)	HK\$90.15
EHang Holdings Ltd (EH.O)	O (03/13/2025)	US\$5.12
Geely Automobile Holdings (0175.HK)	O (06/26/2024)	HK\$18.79
Great Wall Motor Company Limited (601633.SS)	U (03/16/2022)	Rmb16.36
Great Wall Motor Company Limited (2333.HK)	E (01/08/2024)	HK\$9.11
Hesai Group (HSAI.O)	O (07/28/2025)	US\$15.00
Horizon Robotics (9660.HK)	O (12/02/2024)	HK\$4.39
Li Auto Inc. (LI.O)	O (08/24/2020)	US\$12.39
Li Auto Inc. (2015.HK)	O (11/16/2021)	HK\$49.12
NIO Inc. (9866.HK)	O (10/03/2022)	HK\$39.26
NIO Inc. (NIO.N)	O (08/26/2020)	US\$4.88
WeRide Inc (WRD.O)	O (11/19/2024)	US\$5.98
XPeng Inc. (9868.HK)	O (11/16/2021)	HK\$53.10
XPeng Inc. (XPEV.N)	O (01/29/2021)	US\$13.53

Stock Ratings are subject to change. Please see latest research for each company.

* Historical prices are not split adjusted.